PO Guide Part I · Short Notes ✍️

Part I: Organisation of DOP · 23 Circles · History · Clauses 1 to 20

For GDS → MTS · Postman · Mail Guard exams

Yellow = must remember IMP = asked often 📝 PYQ · State-Year = came in a past paper

Red = asked the tricky way

📘 Parts of the PO Guide

PO Guide = 4 parts

- → I Rules for inland post
- → II Rules for foreign post
- → III List of post offices
- → IV Savings bank + PO savings schemes

Part I = 7 sections

I General · II Letter & Parcel · III Official · **IV Prohibited** 📝 PYQ · Haryana 2020 · V Money Order · VI Philately · VII PLI

💡 **Remember**

The 7 sections in order: **"G-L-O-P, M-P-P"** = General, Letter, Official, Prohibited, MO, Philately, PLI

🏛️ Organisation of the Department of Posts (DOP)

- ★ Started by **Lord Dalhousie** · present form from **1 October 1854**
- → IMP DOP comes under the **Ministry of Communications** · in charge = Communications Minister 📝 PYQ · Bihar 2021
- → Administrative control → **DG Post, New Delhi** (all administration + operations)
- → Head of DOP → **Secretary, Department of Posts**
- → Headquarters → **Dak Bhawan, New Delhi**
- → PLI **Directorate** → New Delhi · PLI **Director** → Kolkata
- → IMP Whole country = **23 postal circles** 📝 PYQ · Chhattisgarh 2021 · Delhi 2022 · Telangana 2020
- → A separate wing for the armed forces, the **Army Postal Service (APS)** = **Base Circle**
- → Office of the Controller of Foreign Mails → **Mumbai**

Army Postal Service (APS)

- → Total APOs = 2
- → **56 APO** = New Delhi = **1 CBPO** · PIN **900056**
- → Head: **ADG, APS** · rank = **Major General**
- → Officers come on **deputation** from the civil post

- → 99 APO = Kolkata = 2 CBPO · PIN 900099
- → Headquarters: New Delhi (Sena Dak Bhawan) PYQ · Telangana 2020
- → Other ranks: 75% from DOP + 25% recruited by the Army
- → 2 CBPOs + APS Training Centre Kamptee, Nagpur → Commandants, rank Colonel

Postal Services Board (PSB)

- → The apex management body of DOP = PSB = Chairperson + 6 Members
- → Permanent invitees: DG Postal Services · ADG (Coordination) · AS&FA
- → AS&FA heads the Integrated Finance Wing (IFW) · Secretary to the Board = a senior staff officer of the Directorate

6 Members	Handle
Planning & HRD	HR development, philately, estates, planning
Personnel	Personnel management
PLI	PLI + investment of PLI funds
Banking & DBT	Banking + Direct Benefit Transfer
Operations	Postal operations
Technology	Technology induction + implementation

Top to bottom: who heads what

Unit	Head
Circle	CPMG (Chief Postmaster General)
Region	PMG
Division	SSP / SP PYQ · Delhi 2022 · Maharashtra 2022 · Tamil Nadu 2020
Sub-division	IP / ASP
RMS Division	SRM / SSRM PYQ · Uttarakhand 2020

Circle → Region → Division → Sub-division · Depot (store + stamp depots merged) → Superintendent

At the very top: Minister of Communications → Minister of State → Secretary (Posts) / PSB Chairperson + DG Postal Services

👀 At a glance: Organisation

4	7	23	2	6
PO Guide parts	Part I sections	postal circles	APOs	PSB members

75%
APS staff from DOP

> ⚠️ **Exam trap**
> PLI **Directorate is in Delhi**, but the PLI **Director is in Kolkata**.

> 💡 **Remember**
> **56 = Delhi** (1 CBPO) · **99 = Kolkata** (2 CBPO) · PIN = 900 + APO number

🗺️ The 23 postal circles

Circles with more than one state / UT (asked the most):

Circle	Includes	Trick
North East (HQ **Shillong**)	Manipur, Meghalaya, Mizoram, Arunachal, Tripura, Nagaland = **6** 📝 PYQ · Haryana 2022	MMM + ATN
West Bengal	West Bengal, Andaman & Nicobar, Sikkim	WAS
Maharashtra	Maharashtra, Goa 📝 PYQ · Maharashtra 2022	GM
Gujarat	Gujarat, Dadra Nagar Haveli, Daman & Diu	DDG
Kerala	Kerala, Lakshadweep, **Mahe**	KLM
Punjab	Punjab, Chandigarh	PC
Tamil Nadu	Tamil Nadu, Pondicherry	TP
Andhra Pradesh	Andhra Pradesh, **Yanam**	AY
J&K	Jammu & Kashmir, Ladakh	JL

Headquarters (the red ones differ from the circle name and are asked the tricky way):

Andhra → **Vijayawada** · Assam → Guwahati · Bihar → Patna · Chhattisgarh → Raipur · Delhi → New Delhi · Gujarat → Ahmedabad · Haryana → **Ambala Cantt** · Himachal → Shimla · J&K → Srinagar · Jharkhand → Ranchi · Karnataka → Bengaluru · Kerala → Thiruvananthapuram · MP → Bhopal · Maharashtra → Mumbai · North East → **Shillong** · Odisha → Bhubaneswar · Punjab → **Chandigarh** · Rajasthan → Jaipur · Tamil Nadu → Chennai · Telangana → Hyderabad · UP → Lucknow · Uttarakhand → Dehradun · West Bengal → Kolkata

👀 At a glance: Circles

23	6	+1
circles	states in North East	Base Circle (APS)

⚠️ Exam trap

Mahe belongs to Puducherry but is in the **Kerala** circle · **Yanam** belongs to Puducherry but is in the **Andhra** circle.

💡 Remember

Haryana's HQ is **not** Chandigarh, it is **Ambala Cantt**. Chandigarh = Punjab circle.

🏢 Directorates, institutions, training

Directorate	Where	Deals with
Parcel	Malcha Marg, New Delhi	Parcels, e-commerce, international parcels, EMS
PLI	Chanakyapuri, New Delhi	PLI + RPLI, insurance investment
BD	Dak Bhawan, New Delhi	Retail, business, direct post, POPSK, Aadhaar
APS	Sena Dak Bhawan, New Delhi	Mail of army, paramilitary, navy, air force

Heads of institutions

- Circle → CPMG · Region → PMG · APS → ADG
- GPO → Director / Chief PM / Sr. PM
- CEPT Mysore → **General Manager**
- BD, PLI, Parcel → **CGM** · PTC, RAKNPA → Director
- RLO → Manager · PSD → Superintendent

Training

- **RAKNPA** → **Ghaziabad (UP)** · head: Director · trains Group A, Group B, foreign postal managers
- **CEPT** → **Mysore**
- **PTC = 6**: Saharanpur, Vadodara, Mysore, Madurai, Darbhanga, Guwahati
- **RTC = 4**: Bhubaneswar, Delhi, Nashik, Hubballi

💡 Remember

PTC 6 = "**Saha-Vad-My-Madu-Dar-Gu**" · RTC 4 = "**Bhu-Del-Na-Hu**"

⚠️ Exam trap

CEPT is headed by a **General Manager**, but RAKNPA by a **Director**.

⏳ History of the post

Year	What happened
1727	First post office in **Kolkata**
1774 · 1786 · 1793	GPOs: Kolkata · Chennai · Mumbai
1837	First Post Office Act (for uniformity)
1852	Asia's first adhesive stamp, in Sindh = **Scinde Dawk** (used till June 1866)
1854	New Act (base of the modern post) · **1 Oct** first all-India stamp · **Railway Mail Service** · sea mail to Britain + China
1898	Indian Post Office Act 1898
18 Feb 1911	World's first airmail: **Allahabad → Naini** (about 18 km)
24 Dec 2023	**Post Office Act 2023** notified

💡 **Remember**

"1854 = three things": new Act + first all-India stamp + Railway Mail Service

⚠️ **Exam trap**

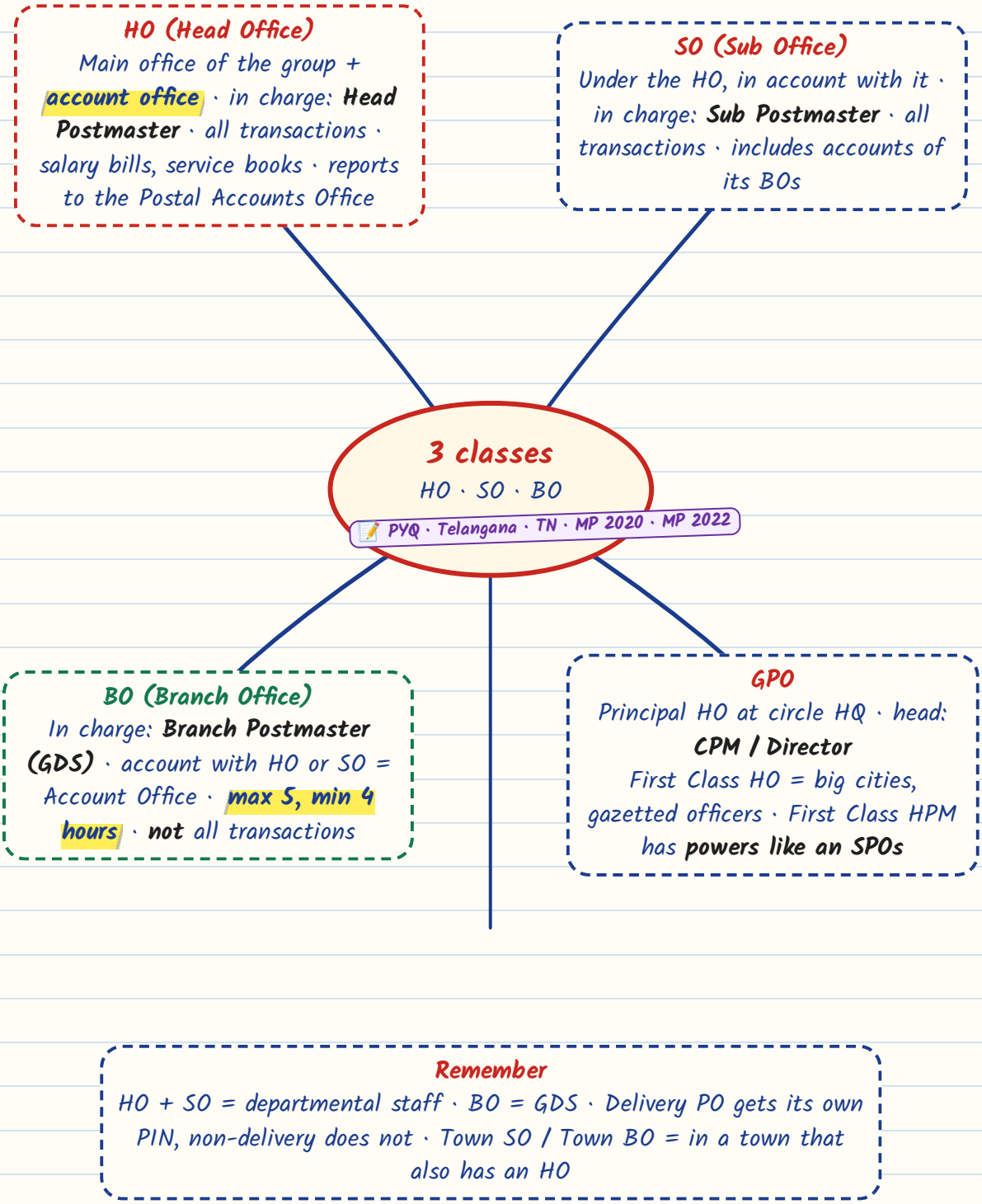
Asia's first stamp was **1852, Sindh**, but the first all-India stamp was **1854**.

✍️ **Test yourself**

1. Which ministry is the DOP under?
2. HQ of the Haryana circle?
3. Which circle is Mahe in?
4. Where is 99 APO?
5. The world's first airmail flew from where to where?

Answers: 1 Communications · 2 Ambala Cantt · 3 Kerala · 4 Kolkata (2 CBPO) · 5 Allahabad → Naini

Clause 2 Classes of post offices · Mind map



Remember

HO + SO = departmental staff · BO = GDS · Delivery PO gets its own PIN, non-delivery does not · Town SO / Town BO = in a town that also has an HO

Clause 2 Classes of post offices

Heads of HOs

Director-headed GPO	Director
Other GPOs	Chief PM / Sr. PM
Non-gazetted HO	Postmaster
1st class gazetted HO	Chief Postmaster
2nd class gazetted HO	Sr. Postmaster

Types of SO (by number of staff)

- → **Time Scale**: MDG, HSG, LSG
- → **Selection Grade**: Triple (A), Double (B), Single handed (C)

7 jobs of a BO

- → Delivery, dispatch, booking, accepting parcels
- → SB deposit + SB withdrawal
- → Issue + payment of money orders

👀 At a glance: Clause 2

3	5	4	7
classes	BO max hours	BO min hours	BO jobs

⚠️ **Exam trap**
HO and SO do **all** transactions (they differ only in a few SB jobs). A BO can **not** do all.

💡 **Remember**
HO = **H**ead, SO = **S**ub, BO = **B**ranch (village, GDS)

Clause 3 Night Post Office

- → IMP Normal working hours fixed by → **Head of Circle (CPMG)**
  📝 PYQ · Maharashtra 2020 · Bihar 2021
- → **DG** can extend any PO's hours up to **8:30 PM** + keep it open on Sunday = Night PO
  📝 PYQ · Chhattisgarh 2021
- → A Night PO does only the work authorised by the DG
- ✓ In extended hours: registered booking (VP included) · IPO + stamp sale · SB deposit + cash certificates (till **7 PM**)
- ✓ Sunday / holiday: **10 AM to 5 PM**
- ✗ Stopped on Sunday / holiday: delivery · SB + PO certificates · MO payment

💡 **Remember**
DG = "**D**oor **G**pen at ni**G**ht" · DG stretches the time

⚠️ **Exam trap**
DG extends hours, **CPMG fixes** normal hours. On Sunday it is **10–5**, not 8:30.

Clause 4 Mobile Post Office

- → A specially designed **van** going to fixed points → **late-posting** facility in cities
- ✓ Stamps + stationery · insured parcels · surface + air registered letter mail · air parcels · unregistered mail · e-MO · My Stamp · postal banking
- ✗ **No VP booking** · **closed** on Sundays and postal holidays
- → MO booking allowed only at mobile POs of **Madras and Nagpur**

> 💡 **Remember**
> Mobile: **no VP** · MO only in **Ma-Na** (Madras, Nagpur)

> ⚠️ **Exam trap**
> The mobile PO is also **closed on Sunday**. Only the Night PO is open on Sunday.

Clause 5 Business hours

- → Hours clearly notified at every PO + RMS office · counter work stops **exactly** at the fixed time
- → Fixed with regard to: **local convenience + arrival / departure of mail**

📝 PYQ · Haryana 2022

Work	Week days	Saturday
Enquiry, stamps & stationery sale, certificate of posting 📝 PYQ · Assam 2020	**Entire hours**	Entire hours
Registered, insured, VP, parcel booking	**6–7 hrs**	**5 hrs**, till 3 PM
MO, postal orders, SB, certificates, phone bills 📝 PYQ · Delhi 2022	**about 5 hrs**	**3 hrs**, till 1 PM

- → IMP **POs in charge of GDS: max 5 hours**

📝 PYQ · Chhattisgarh 2021 · Kerala 2021 · MP 2020 · TN 2020

- → Window delivery of registered / insured / VP + MO payment → during the booking hours of that class
- → Most stationary RMS offices: registered booking + stamp & stationery sale

👀 At a glance: Clauses 3–5

8:30	10–5	7 PM	5 hrs	6–7
Night PO till	Night PO Sunday	SB deposit till	GDS PO max	registered booking hrs

⚠️ Exam trap

VP articles and MOs can **not** be booked to an Army Post Office address.

📝 PYQ · Maharashtra 2020 · Haryana 2020

💡 Remember

Saturday: registered till **3 PM**, money work till **1 PM** (money closes first)

Clause 7 Sundays and postal holidays

- → All POs except Night POs are **closed** (mobile too) → no public business + street letter boxes not cleared
- ✓ Late letters can go in: RMS letter boxes · selected offices · mail van letter boxes of RMS
- ✗ Machine-franked articles must **not** go in: PO letter boxes · mail van letter boxes
- → Registered newspapers **without late fee** at: press sorting offices · RMS offices · Night POs
- → RMS offices (fixed hours): stamps, stationery, certificate of posting + registered on late fee

Clause 8 Post office holidays

Total **17** = **14 compulsory** + **3** varying by circle

3 National

Republic Day · Independence Day · Gandhi Jayanti

11 Religious

Budh Purnima, Dussehra, Guru Nanak Jayanti, Mahaveer Jayanti, Eid ul Fitr, Muharram, Diwali, Christmas, Good Friday, Bakrid, Eid-e-Milad

👀 At a glance: Clauses 7–8

₹3	₹2	17	14	3
late fee registered	late fee unregistered	total holidays	compulsory	by circle

💡 **Remember**

17 = 14 + 3 · 14 = 3 national + 11 religious

⚠️ **Exam trap**

Registered **newspapers** pay **no late fee** on Sunday, but registered **articles** pay ₹3.

Clause 9 Why prepay postage

- → Fully prepaid articles → go by the **earliest mail** + are delivered fast
- ✗ Unpaid / underpaid: **no extra security** · may be **detained** to tax the postage due · **not** issued with special deliveries

💡 **Remember**

Full stamp = full speed 🚀

Clause 10 Postage stamps and stationery

- → Postage is normally paid with **postage stamps** · issued by **India Post** under the **authority of the Government of India**
- → Stationery (envelopes, inland letter cards, postcards) has the stamp embossed · if more postage is needed, add **extra stamps**
- → Postage can also be paid by **franking machine** impressions
- → Overseas philately orders → **Indian Philatelic Bureau, Bombay GPO**

⚠️ **Exam trap**

Revenue stamp: the PO only **sells** it, the **Central Government** issues it, and it can **not** be used for postage. 📝 PYQ · MP 2020

✍️ Test yourself

1. Night PO timing on Sunday?
2. Which article can't be booked at a mobile PO?
3. Max hours of a PO in charge of GDS?
4. Total postal holidays?
5. Late fee for an unregistered article?

Answers: 1 10 AM to 5 PM · 2 VP · 3 5 hours · 4 17 · 5 ₹2

Franking · Franking machine · Mind map



Franking Key points

- Machine number **X123456**: X = maker (**F** Francotyp Postalia, **N** Neopost, **P** Pitney Bowes) + 6 digits
- Funds kept safe in the **PSD (Postal Security Device)** · maker's server dials the DOP server **3 times a day**
- New licence **14 working days** · renewal **5 working days** (start 1 month before expiry) · rejected → fee back in 30 working days
- Bring: **window delivery ticket** (identification) + 2 copies of the SOM · **3% commission** on value of franks
- Govt departments: advance ₹2000 to ₹9900 · receipt **ACG-67** · 2 offices incl. 1 HO (LSG or above) · word "Service" in the licence die · registers kept 2 years

👀 At a glance: Franking

5 yrs	₹375	2	3%	30 days
licence valid	fee	max POs	rebate / commission	server dial

⚠️ Exam trap

Older rule: impression **red**, but **RMFM impression is blue**. If the question says "RMFM / Digi Frank", answer blue.

💡 Remember

Franked mail **not in letter boxes** · if posted there = **Unpaid**

Clause 12 Prepayment of postage in cash

- For firms posting very large numbers of unregistered packets → certain POs authorised by the **Head of Circle**
- Minimum: **500 in big cities** · **250 in small towns** at a time
- Some POs in Bombay, Kolkata, Madras, Nagpur, Delhi → registration fee also in cash (with special registered journals)
- Selected gazetted / HSG POs → firms posting at least **500 articles**
- ✓ Available for: letters, ILCs, postcards, packets, unregistered articles, registered newspapers 📝 PYQ · Chhattisgarh 2022 · **not** for others
- Special registration envelopes (from the PO) → **registered articles only**

Clauses 13–14 Spoilt and fictitious stamps

- **Not valid** for postage: cut, torn, defaced, obliterated, over-printed, imperfect stamps, or stamps cut from embossed envelopes
- Re-using a used stamp to cause loss to the government = **offence under the IPC**
- IMP Making / using fictitious stamps = punishable under **Section 263-A, IPC 1860**
  PYQ · Tamil Nadu 2020
- Reproduction allowed for illustration in philatelic publications, only in **black**

> 💡 **Remember**
> **263-A** = fictitious stamps · philatelic reproduction = **black**

> ⚠️ **Exam trap**
> 500 packets in **big cities**, 250 in **small towns**. Don't swap them.

Clauses 15–16 Packing and sealing

- IMP Every letter / packet / parcel gets date stamps of at least **2 POs**: **booking + destination**
  PYQ · Rajasthan · Jharkhand · Andhra 2021 · Bihar · MP · Delhi 2022
- Strong cover: pressure + friction in mail bags + stamping pressure
- The PO takes **no special precaution** for fragile articles
- Wax cloth → **inside** cover, strong paper outside (for date stamps and stamps) · no sharp edges
- **Avoid sealing wax** outside unregistered articles · if used, lay **thin tissue paper** over it · especially for foreign mail through hot climates

Clause 17 Coins and valuables

Coins, bullion, precious stones, jewellery, gold / silver articles, currency notes → inland **only insured**
PYQ · Gujarat 2020

- "Gold or silver articles" include partly made of them (not coins)
- "Coins" exclude cut counterfeit coins sent by the currency department · "notes" exclude cancelled cut notes
- "Jewellery" includes **watches** with gold / silver cases

Clauses 18–20 Letter boxes

- Letters, postcards, ILCs, packets → letter boxes at POs, public places, mobile POs, steamers
- ✗ IMP Machine-franked articles **not** in letter boxes
  PYQ · Bihar 2021 · 2022 · Delhi 2022

- "Letters only" boxes → only letters · other articles in air mail / QMS boxes are **detained**
- QMS articles need the **full PIN** below the town name
- Large letters that don't fit → at the window · bulk letters too, if postage + late fee are paid

👀 At a glance: Clauses 12–20

500	250	263-A	2 POs
packets big cities	packets small towns	fictitious stamp IPC	date stamps

⚠️ Exam trap

Valuables go **insured**, not just registered.

💡 Remember

2 stamps = **booking + destination** ("where it left, where it reached")

✍️ Test yourself

1. Franking licence fee and validity?
2. A franked article posted in a letter box is treated as?
3. Fictitious stamps are an offence under which section?
4. Date stamps of how many POs on every article?
5. How are coins sent inland?

Answers: 1 ₹375, 5 years · 2 Unpaid · 3 IPC 263-A · 4 2 (booking + destination) · 5 Insured only

Source: PO Guide Part I · MTS / Postman notes, pages 1–27, condensed

PO Guide Part I · Short Notes ✍️

Part 2: Posting at the window · affixing stamps · addressing · packing special items · defence mail · post boxes · letter boxes · official articles (Section III) · prohibited articles (Section IV)

Yellow = must remember IMP = asked often 📝 PYQ · State-Year = came in a past paper

Clauses 20–22 Articles handed in at the window

- All **parcels**, whatever the weight → at the **counter** of a PO / mail office
- Registered newspapers + franked articles → at the counter named in the licence
- IMP Registered / insured / VP / certificate-of-posting articles → at least **half an hour before** the mail closes
- Mark clearly above the address: "Registered" / "Insured for ₹..." / "Value Payable for ₹..."
- Air mail with high-value adhesive stamps → at the window, stamps defaced in the **presence** of the person presenting it
- Posting just as the mail leaves → congestion + delay. **Post early** (Clause 22)

Clauses 23–25 How to affix stamps

- IMP Stamps → **right-hand top corner** of the address side
  📝 PYQ · Rajasthan 2021 · Maharashtra 2022 · Chhattisgarh 2021
- Stamps must stick fully to the **article itself**, not to its contents or a separate label
- Non-postal stamps, charity stamps, labels, seals → **not** on the address side (make the address hard to read)
- **No** impressions that look like a franking machine impression
- Use the minimum number of stamps (Clause 25) → many small stamps take space + add work for staff

✉️ How to write the address

- Wrong / incomplete address = delay or wrong delivery · it must be complete enough to deliver without enquiry
- Address **parallel to the length** of the cover, in the **lower half, towards the right**
- Leave at least **3 cm** clear at the top (stamps, labels, postmarks)
- Post town in **block letters**, approved spelling · foreign addresses in **Roman** letters

- Two post towns with the same name → add the **district** · district and town same name → add the **state**
- IMP Sender's address → **lower left-hand corner** or on the back

PYQ · Chhattisgarh 2021 · MP 2020

- Concession / free articles (Book post, Blind literature) → write the class at the top of the address side
- Bulky letter that may look like another class → write "Letter" on it

Town address (order)

Name → designation / profession → house no. + street → locality → post town + PIN → mobile

Village address (order)

Name → father's / husband's name → house no. → village + thana → PO of delivery + PIN → taluka, district, state (not needed with the right PIN) → mobile

Machine-sortable envelopes (standard): receiver's address on the front, sender's on the back · **15 mm** blank on left, bottom, right · address block **40 mm** below the top · stamps / frank 10 mm from the address · **15 mm** at the bottom for the barcode · logo max 25 × 50 mm

The President and certain high officers get mail even on tour (list in Clause 206) → address such articles "Camp", not a post town.

👀 At a glance: stamps and address

½ hr	3 cm	15 mm	40 mm
registered before close	top margin	edges / barcode	address from top

⚠️ **Exam trap**

Stamps go **top right**, but the sender's address goes **bottom left**. Don't swap them.

💡 **Remember**

"**Stamp sits up-right, sender sits down-left**"

📦 Packing special items

- Parcels in a strong case / wrapper · cloth / woollens → strong wrapper + outer cover · wooden or stout cardboard box is best
- **Live bees** → in cases that can't hurt other mail or staff

- **Liquids** → **double receptacle**: bottle inside, metal / strong wooden box outside, saw-dust / bran in between (to absorb)
- **Human viscera** → may go to Chemical Examiners · brains of rabid animals to authorised labs · glass bottle, tight stopper (wax if alcohol), in a wooden / tin box with **18 mm cotton**, cloth outside, seals every **3 inches**
- **Plague cultures** → only from authorised doctors / with govt permission, to a govt lab · hermetically closed + 18 mm layer + declaration
- **Osmic acid** → sealed glass capsule, in a tin of sand (at least **4.3 cm**), wooden box outside + 2.5 cm cotton · red letters "OSMIC ACID" · max **2 grams** per capsule
- **Perfumes** → plugged bottle, cardboard box, then wooden box · red letters "Perfumes - keep away from fire"

> 💡 **Remember**
> Liquid = **"bottle inside a box"** · osmic acid = **2 grams** · viscera / cultures = **18 mm** cotton

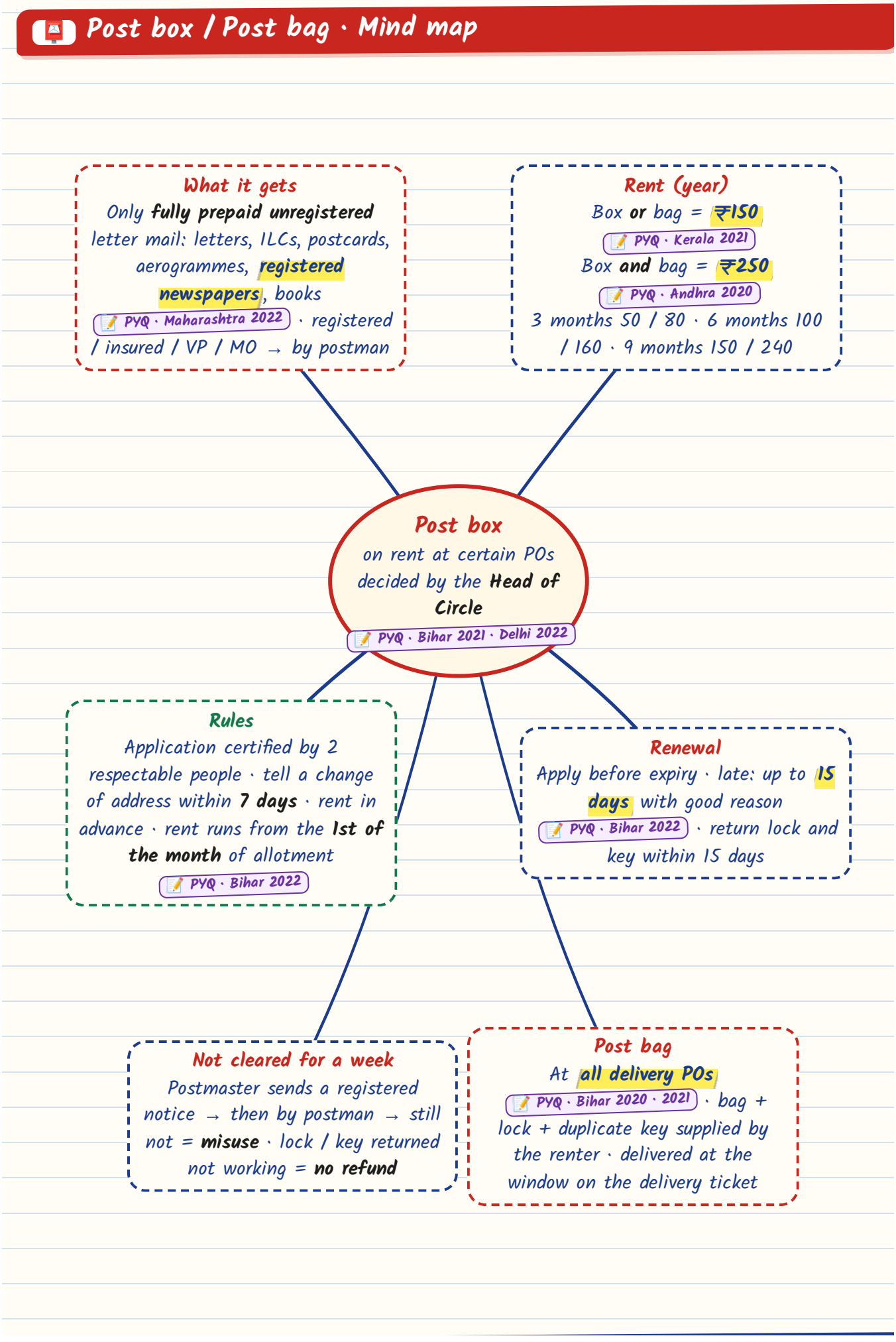
Clauses 27–31 Army, navy, addresses

- IMP Army / Air Force personnel → PIN of **56 APO or 99 APO**, **no post town**
  📝 PYQ · Maharashtra 2022
- IMP Navy personnel on INS ships → **C/o Fleet Mail Office, Bombay** + number, rank, ship's name
  📝 PYQ · Punjab 2021 · Chhattisgarh 2022 · Bihar 2021 · MP 2020 · Odisha 2021
- **Indefinite address** = not delivered: addressed to a class of people, only initials / figures / fictitious names · **unless** in care of a definite person or place (house, post box, street number)
- Registered / insured / VP / MO → only to a **definite person or firm**
- Sender's name + address (with PIN) in the **lower left** corner → returned unopened if not delivered (Clause 30)
- Many undelivered articles are destroyed every year in RLOs · for photographs in packets write the address on the back too
- When giving your address to people abroad, always mention the **state** (Clause 31)

Definite ✓ (delivered)	Indefinite ✗ (not delivered)
The Chief Secretary to the Government of HP, Shimla	Chief Secretary, Shimla
The Occupant, No. 10 Park Street, Kolkata	The non-commissioned officer, Meerut
President, Officers' Mess, **Mathura** (only one mess)	President, Officers' Mess, **Delhi** (many messes)

The certificate of posting service was discontinued in 2011 (not in syllabus).

Post box / Post bag · Mind map



Post box: other points

- Articles "C/o Post Box" are not put in the box, except for: the firm's staff, family / guests, trainees of an institution, visitors staying with the renter
- Several renters may share one box, but **each pays a separate fee** · no right to a particular number / row
- Wrong information or misuse → box withdrawn without notice
- Key lost → pay for the key only · lock (or both) lost → pay for both · not reporting = allotment cancelled
- Delivery ticket = same number as the box, **not transferable** · clearance may be stopped up to half an hour before each delivery
- Article too big for the box → intimation slip inside, collect at the window · too much mail → extra box with the **same number**

👀 At a glance: Post box

₹150	₹250	7 days	15 days	1 week
box or bag / yr	both / yr	report address change	late renewal	not cleared → notice

⚠️ Exam trap

Post **boxes** = at certain POs, but post **bags** = at **all delivery POs**.

💡 Remember

"**150 single, 250 pair**" (₹150 one, ₹250 both)

Letter box attendant (LB peon)

- IMP Main duty = **clearing the letter boxes of his beat on time**

  📝 PYQ · Tamil Nadu 2020 · Haryana 2020 · Andhra 2020
- Stamping, sealing, unloading mail · reports damaged boxes to the postmaster · knows clearance and mail times
- Gets keys + hour plates + a bag from the postmaster before leaving · returns them at once · keys always kept by the postmaster
- May carry mail to town SOs / BOs, work as packers · **no MO payments other than TMOs**
- **Nayatha software + PMA app**: scan the barcode inside the box → GPRS to the server, GPS checked
- Who clears: GDS DA / MTS / Postman · office boxes → **BPM** in a BO, GDS DA / MTS / Mail PA in SOs / HOs

Section III — Official postal articles (Clauses 198–207)

📝 PYQ · Bihar 2021

- Same rates and rules as non-official mail · exceptions: "Service Unpaid" postcards, parcels with official files
- Department of Posts officers, Postal Audit officers → departmental mail **free**
- Superscription **OIGS (On India Government Service)** or **On Service** + sender's **signature + full designation** (lower left)
- Service postcards already carry "Service" → nothing more needed · known abbreviations may be accepted, but no one can claim it
- IMP Unpaid official article → charged the **prepaid rate** on delivery · underpaid → **only the deficiency** 📝 PYQ · Chhattisgarh 2021 · Andhra 2020 · Kerala 2021
- Prepayment on parcels is **compulsory** · an official parcel with dues goes back to the sender
- Entitled to service stamps: Central, State, local bodies, judiciary · authorised by the **DG** (later changes: Head of Circle) · officials on leave / retired: **no**
- A postal ballot = an official postal article
- Mail of local fund / local authority officers = **not** official (can't use OIGS)
- Ordinary stamps used instead of service stamps → the PO in charge reports it to the sending office · repeated → to the **CPMG**
- Govt officer → private person: official, prepaid · exceptions: certified court copies, govt books → "Service Unpaid", charged on delivery
- Govt officers **must** pay postage due on articles addressed to them · **not** with service stamps

Camp mail (Clauses 205–206)

- High constitutional / govt officers on tour → their mail in a **special registered mail bag** (Camp Correspondence)
- Only fully prepaid, uninsured letter mail · addressed "Camp", no post town · bags delivered on **Sundays + holidays** too
- Parcels, MOs, insured, VP with dues → **not** in special bags · no redirection in transit
- Camp bag (files): as parcel → max **10 kg**, postage of a 10 kg parcel + registration + **₹16** · as air parcel → + **₹6** · as letter mail → registration fee only · 2 labels (address + tag)
- Tour programme given in time to the Department (Council of Ministers → **DG Post, New Delhi**) · changes to them + the local superintendent

✍️ **Test yourself**

1. Mail for INS ships goes in care of?
2. Yearly rent for post box + bag?
3. Where is the post bag facility?
4. Charge on an underpaid official article?
5. Top margin above the address?

Answers: 1 Fleet Mail Office, Bombay · 2 ₹250 · 3 All delivery POs · 4 Only the deficiency · 5 3 cm

Section IV Prohibited articles (Clause 209) 📝 PYQ · Haryana 2020

- ✗ Anything sent against any law in force
- ✗ Indecent paintings, photos, books, cards 📝 PYQ · Andhra 2021
- ✗ Indecent, seditious, threatening words on the cover
- ✗ Explosive, inflammable, dangerous, filthy things · **matches** count as explosives
- ✗ Inflammable liquids: flash point below **200°F** · spirits 90°F or below · turpentine · all varnishes
- ✗ Harmful living creatures
- ✗ IMP **Lottery** tickets / adverts 📝 PYQ · MP 2020 · govt lotteries exempt (declaration + name and address)
- ✗ Newspapers not following the Press & Registration of Books Act 1867
- ✗ IMP Gold coins / bullion / ornaments over **₹1 lakh** (earlier ₹20,000) 📝 PYQ · Kerala 2021
- ✗ Coins, currency notes (DG may allow for specific purposes)
- ✗ Address side split into several parts (more than one address)
- ✗ Dangerous goods, narcotics, items banned by IATA / ICAO / wildlife · batteries banned by air → surface only

Don't use pins to join reply postcards or packet covers (they injure other mail).

Local prohibitions (Clause 210)

- → Anywhere in India: **opium, morphia, coca leaves, bhang, ganja, charas, cocaine** → prohibited · exempt: recognised medicines, govt consignments, licensed chemists (permit + declaration)
- → Skins / feathers of birds other than domestic birds → prohibited (exempt: ostrich feathers, natural history specimens to / from Port Blair)
- → **Kutch** out of J&K → only with a permit from the Conservator of Forests, Kashmir
- → Pests / disease: plants with **San Jose** scale from several states · **Icerya purchasi** from TN, Kerala, Karnataka · **bananas** from Maharashtra, Kerala, Odisha (Bunchy top disease)

Injurious and suspect articles (Clauses 211–213)

- Suspected injurious → postmaster detains it and refers to the **Head of Circle**
- Articles with pins: found at the booking PO → returned at once · found later → returned through the RLO, pins removed
- Goods against the law → returned to the sender · only suspected → forwarded marked "Doubtful", opened in the **presence** of the addressee
- Imported gold / jewellery → only after **customs duty** is paid
- Matter against law and order, harmful to a community, or a picture of a proclaimed offender → not sent, if found → **RLO**

👀 At a glance: Prohibited

₹1 lakh	200°F	1867	Section IV
gold limit	flash point	newspaper Act	prohibited

⚠️ Exam trap

Matches count as "explosives" · **government lotteries** are not prohibited.

💡 Remember

Gold **not above 1 lakh** · top banned trio "**L-G-M**" = Lottery, Gold, Matches

✍️ Test yourself

1. Gold above what value can't go by post?
2. A suspect article is opened in whose presence?
3. Which lottery tickets are not prohibited?
4. Bananas can't be sent from which states?

Answers: 1 ₹1 lakh · 2 The addressee · 3 Government lotteries · 4 Maharashtra, Kerala, Odisha

Source: PO Guide Part I · MTS / Postman notes, pages 28–54, condensed

PO Guide Part I · Short Notes ✍️

Part 3: Mail products · 10 classes of articles · letters, ILC, postcards, book packets, RNP, parcels · registration · insurance · VPP · Speed Post · Business Parcel · international mail

Yellow = must remember IMP = asked often 📝 PYQ · State-Year = came in a past paper

Rates are as given in the notes (for the exam). Actual counter rates may have changed since.

Clause 214 The address side

- Anything written / printed / attached on the address side that hinders reading the address → **not transmitted**
- Stamps that were once valid but are no longer in use → not transmitted · if found in transit, **returned to the sender**

📦 Mail products and the 10 classes

Premium products

Speed Post · Logistic Post · Business Post · Direct Post · Media Post · e-Post

Traditional products

Ordinary letters, postcards, ILCs · Registered · Insured letters · Parcels · VPP · Packets

First class (1–3)	Second class (4–10)
1 Letter · 2 Inland Letter Card (ILC) · 3 Postcard	4 Book packet · 5 Book packet with printed books · 6 Book packet with periodicals · 7 Blind literature · 8 Sample / pattern packet · 9 Registered newspaper (RNP) · 10 Parcel

- First **9** = letter mail · the last **1** = parcel mail
- IMP **All Up scheme**: first-class mail goes by air within India **without any air surcharge**
- RNP is sorted like first-class mail, but gets **no** free air transmission

1–3 Letters, ILC, postcards

Letter

- Any communication closed in an envelope · max weight **2 kg** · postage first **20 g ₹5** + ₹5 per extra 20 g

- → Size: min **14 × 9 cm** · any one side max 60 cm · length + breadth + depth ≤ **90 cm** · roll: diameter 10–80 cm, length + 2×diameter 17–100 cm
- → Flap at the back on the longer side · paper 0.08–0.18 mm, at least **70 GSM**, bends into a "U" · no metal clips / staples
- ✗ Unpaid letter → **double the postage** · underpaid → **double the deficiency**

Inland Letter Card (ILC)

- → Price **₹2.50** · max weight **5 grams** PYQ · Chhattisgarh 2021
- → Unfolded max 30 × 21 cm (min 28.2 × 18.2) · folded max 21 × 10 cm (min 15.2 × 9)
- → Unpaid → double · underpaid → double the deficiency · breaking the rules → taxed as a letter
- → Private ILCs allowed (DOP sizes) · **not** for foreign countries, except **Pakistan and Nepal**

Postcard

- → Size **14 × 9 cm** PYQ · Andhra 2021 · private cards just as thick
- → **Nothing** can be attached to a postcard PYQ · Punjab 2021
- → Meghdoot: advertisement in **4 colours** next to the address
- → Competition card: for TV / radio / newspaper contests (now discontinued)

Card	Price
Single	₹0.50
Reply	₹1
Printed	₹6
Meghdoot	₹0.25
Competition	₹10

👀 At a glance: letters, ILC, cards

2 kg	₹5	5 g	14×9	25 p
letter max	per 20 g	ILC max	postcard cm	Meghdoot

⚠️ **Exam trap**
ILCs can't go abroad, **except to Pakistan and Nepal.**

💡 **Remember**
Unpaid = **×2 postage** · underpaid = **×2 deficiency**

4–8 Book packets, blind literature, samples

- → IMP Book packet max **5 kg** PYQ · Chhattisgarh 2021 · size min 10 × 7 cm, max 60 × 30 × 30 cm (roll 10–80 cm)
- → Postage: first **50 g ₹4** + ₹3 per 50 g · air surcharge ₹2 for the first 50 g, then ₹1

- ✗ **No personal / written communication** PYQ · MP 2020 · no money, stamps, cheques · a card headed "Postcard" can't go as a book packet
- ✓ Allowed: greetings, invitations, circulars, horoscopes, pictures, maps · newspapers, printed music · hand-drawn business / legal documents
- ✗ Court summons / notices → **not** as book packets
- → Rules broken → charged letter or parcel postage (whichever applies) · over size / weight → returned · unpaid → double
- → **Printed books** (no adverts, e.g. textbooks) → **₹1 per 100 g**, 5 kg · mark "Printed Books"
- → **Periodicals** → registered with the RNI, price printed on the cover
- → **Sample / pattern** → bona fide trade samples · max **2 kg** · other rules as book packets
- → IMP **Blind literature** → max **7 kg** PYQ · Bihar 2021 · Delhi 2022 · Chhattisgarh 2021 · postage + registration + AD fees **free** · free only by **surface** · marked "Literature for the Blind" · in Braille, ordinary type only for title / contents

9 Registered newspapers (RNP)

- → News, published in large numbers at intervals of **not more than 31 days** · follow the RNI + Press & Registration Act 1867
- → Registered by the area's **SP / SSP** (or an independent gazetted postmaster) · "Registered" + number on the first / last page
- → Number format: **DN/XYZ/2024-2026** (DN = division, XYZ = number, 3-year block) PYQ · Andhra 2021
- → First registration valid till **31 December** of the third calendar year · each renewal for **3 years**
- → **No** registration fee · renewal ₹50 (after 30 Sep, before 31 Dec) · after expiry ₹100
- → List of at least **50 subscribers** · at least **100 copies** at a time · max **5 kg**
- → Postage: single copy first 50 g ₹0.25, 50–100 g ₹0.50, ₹0.20 per extra 100 g · packet up to 100 g ₹0.50 + ₹0.20

10 Parcels

- → **Anything** except prohibited articles · may contain **one** personal letter to the addressee
- → Any other written communication → **double** letter postage each · suspected → "for open delivery", opened before the addressee · if unpaid, recovered from the sender

- IMP Weight: parcel max **20 kg** · registered parcel from / to a BO **10 kg** · unregistered parcel **4 kg**
  PYQ · Maharashtra 2020 · Chhattisgarh 2021 · Kerala 2021 · Delhi 2022
  PYQ · Odisha · Punjab 2021 · Kerala 2020
- Postage: first 500 g **₹19** + **₹16** per 500 g · home delivery charge above 5 kg
- IMP Parcel found in a letter box → treated and charged as a **registered parcel**
  PYQ · Andhra 2021
- International parcel lost: 40 SDR per parcel + 4.50 SDR per kg

👀 At a glance: weights

2 kg	5 kg	2 kg	7 kg	20 kg
letter	book packet / RNP	sample packet	blind	parcel

10 kg	35 kg
BO parcel	Speed Post

⚠️ **Exam trap**
Blind literature **7 kg** (the highest in letter mail) · BO parcels **10 kg**, others 20 kg.

💡 **Remember**
"**2-5-7-20-35**" = letter · book · blind · parcel · speed

🔒 Registration

- Registered articles pass with special care, but the PO is **not** liable for loss / damage
- Can be registered: letters, ILCs, book / pattern packets, blind literature, RNP, postcards, parcels · postage + fee **prepaid** · at the window, receipt given
- IMP Registration **compulsory**: **insured articles** PYQ · Bihar 2021 · Delhi 2022 · MP 2022 · parcels needing a customs declaration · articles with stamps / cheques / hundis / notes · VP articles
- Fees: registration **₹17** · AD **₹3** · from 01-11-2023, **18% GST** on (postage + registration)
- Compensation (an act of grace, not legal liability): Head of Circle up to **₹100** · international registered 30 SDR
- Copy of the receipt signed by the addressee within **6 months** (₹2)

Insurance

- All charges (postage + registration + insurance) **prepaid** · stamps spaced apart so they don't hide damage
- Insured value ≤ real value · gold, coins, notes → insured for the **actual value**
- IMP To / from Army Post Offices: max **₹500**
- **Compulsory** for: coins, bullion, precious stones, gold / silver, notes · VP amount above **₹1500** (except papers / books of no intrinsic value)
- Packing: strong cover, **identical wax seals** on every flap (private mark, not a coin) · no black / coloured borders or transparent windows · gold → wooden / metal case
- At the window · value in words and figures, no corrections · sender's address bottom left · AD **free**
- Compensation paid **1 month** after the loss is reported · never more than the value lost

No compensation when: wrong / incomplete address · fraud · addressee signed the receipt · loss not reported within **3 months** · poor packing · no visible damage to cover / seals · notes / gold not insured for actual value · halves of notes · damage from the nature of the article · prohibited contents

VPP (Value Payable Post)

- The addressee pays when taking delivery; the money goes to the sender by **MO**
- Can go VP: registered parcels, letters, book packets, RNP · **not** "Snowball" (coupon / ticket) schemes
- Declaration: sent on a bona fide order · documents of no intrinsic value allowed (railway receipts, bills, policies)
- Only **MO office to MO office** · amount in the form · on the article: **"VP" + amount at the upper left**, sender's address lower left
- Bulk VP: at least **10** uninsured VP articles · enquire with the local SPOs
- IMP Not taken within **7 days** → returned on the **8th day**
  PYQ · UP 2020 · Chhattisgarh 2021 · written request + fee for 7 more days (fee not refunded)
- On return the sender pays any dues · prepaid fees are never refunded
- Complaints within **6 months**, a fee per article (refunded if right) · suspected fraud → Head of Circle may withhold payment
- Govt is liable only once the amount is received within 6 months · insured value and VP amount can differ (a repaired watch)

👀 At a glance: registration, insurance, VP

₹17	₹3	₹100	₹500	₹1500
registration fee	AD	registered compensation	APO insurance limit	VP needs insurance

7 days — VP detention

> ⚠️ **Exam trap**
> Report an insured loss within **3 months**; money is paid **1 month** after reporting.

> 💡 **Remember**
> "**Insured means registered too**" · VP = wait 7 days, back on day 8

⚡ Speed Post

- The Department's **flagship** product · rate by distance + weight · up to 50 g anywhere **₹35**, local **₹15** (taxes extra)
- IMP Max weight **35 kg** 📝 PYQ · Kerala 2020 · Haryana 2022 · Chhattisgarh 2022 · MP 2022 · insurance up to **₹1 lakh**
- Tracking: **13-character** number on indiapost.gov.in or the "Post Info" app
- Compensation: **double the charges or ₹1000** (whichever is less) · treated as lost after **60 days** from booking or 30 days from complaint (whichever is later)
- Contract customers: money back guarantee, BNPL, COD up to **₹50,000**, discounts (+1% with advance deposit, +2% above ₹25 lakh a month)
- Delivery in a BO takes **1 extra day** · size: one side or length + girth not over 150 cm
- Treated as a Speed Post parcel if: over **500 g** · larger than 38 × 27 × 2 cm · or declared "Merchandise"

Business Parcel

Contract customers · premium surface service · free pick-up, BNPL, COD ₹50,000 · insurance **optional** · uninsured loss: **₹500 or actual value** (whichever is less)

🌍 International mail

- Foreign mail is processed at **Offices of Exchange**: **Mumbai, Delhi, Kolkata, Chennai, Kochi**
- Services: letters, postcards, aerogrammes, small packets, blind literature, printed papers, **M Bag** (newspapers / books for one addressee)

- Registration: letters, small packets, printed papers → **₹150** per article · registered M Bag lost: 150 SDR
- **EMS (International Speed Post)**: max **35 kg** · one side 1.5 m, length + girth 3 m · merchandise lost: value or **130 SDR** · delay over 5 days → 5% of postage
- International parcel: length 1.05 m, length + girth 2 m · min surface 90 × 140 mm · **customs declaration required** · compensation 40 SDR + 4.50 SDR / kg, max 130 SDR
- **SAL** (Surface Air Lifted) = surface inside the country, air between countries
- Paid for delivering inward mail: EMS merchandise min 5 SDR · parcels 7 SDR
- **International Tracked Packet** → e-commerce, to the **Asia-Pacific** region
  📝 PYQ · Bihar 2020 · compensation ₹1000 or actual value

👀 At a glance: speed and foreign

35 kg	₹1 lakh	13	60 days	5
Speed / EMS	Speed insurance	tracking characters	treated as lost	Offices of Exchange

₹150
foreign registration

⚠️ **Exam trap**
Speed Post compensation = **double charges or ₹1000, whichever is less** (not the higher one).

💡 **Remember**
Offices of Exchange = "**Mu-De-Ko-Che-Ko**" (Mumbai, Delhi, Kolkata, Chennai, Kochi)

✍️ Test yourself

1. Max weight of a blind literature packet?
2. A registered parcel from a BO can weigh up to?
3. A parcel found in a letter box is treated as?
4. A VP article is returned after how many days?
5. Max weight of Speed Post?
6. To which countries can an ILC go?

Answers: 1 7 kg · 2 10 kg · 3 A registered parcel · 4 On the 8th day (after 7) · 5 35 kg · 6 Pakistan, Nepal

Source: PO Guide Part 1 · MTS / Postman notes, pages 55–81, condensed

PO Guide Part I · Short Notes ✍️

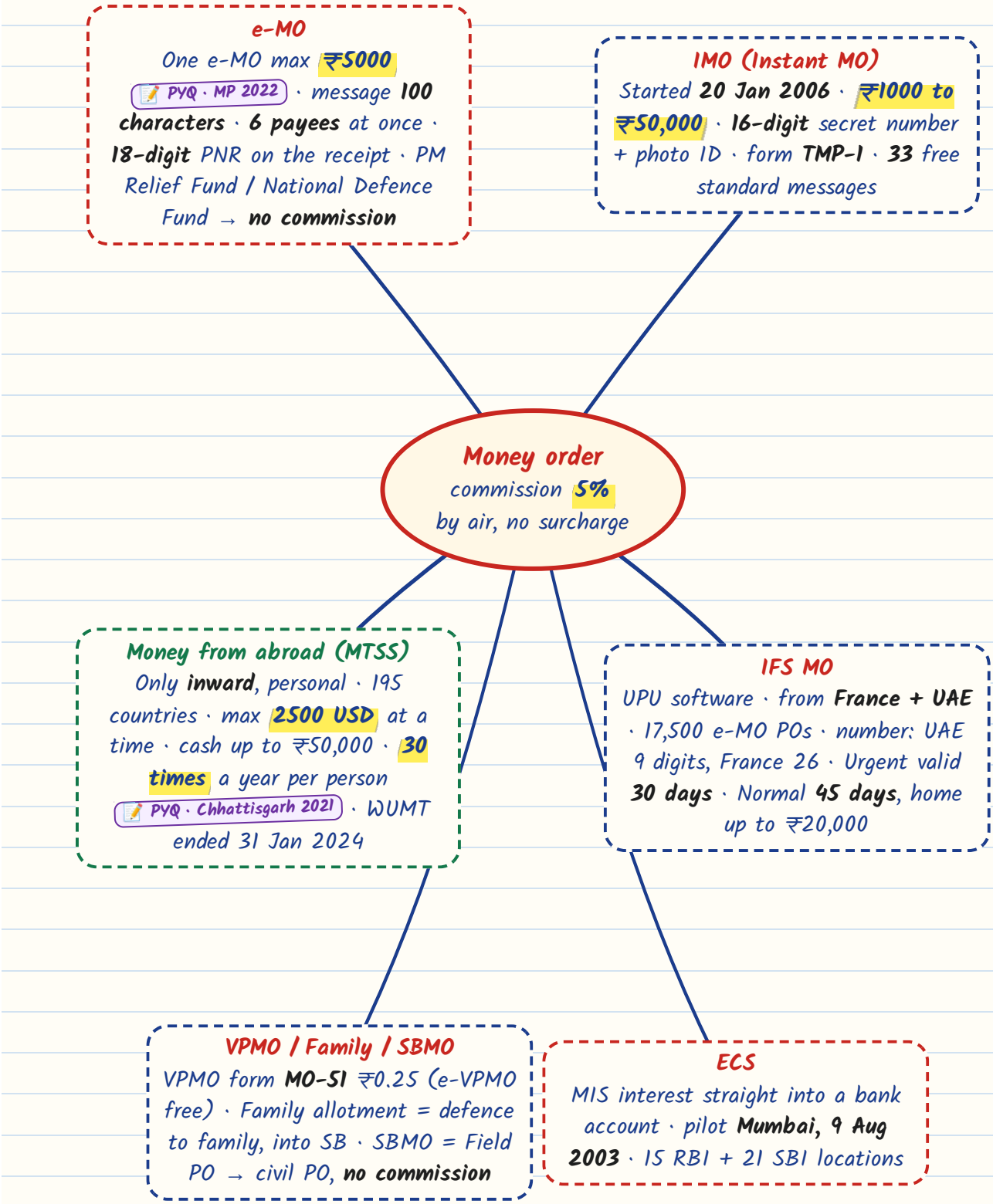
Part 4: Exports by post · money orders, e-MO, IMO, inward foreign money · stamps and philately · My Stamp · NPS · PMSBY · PMJJBY

Yellow = must remember IMP = asked often PYQ · State-Year = came in a past paper

📤 Exports by post

- Started at 5 FPOs (Delhi, Mumbai, Chennai, Kolkata, Kochi) → now exports from **28 locations**
- An exporter with a valid **IEC (Import-Export Code)** → files a **Postal Bill of Export** (Export by Post Regulations 2018)
- **PBE-I** = e-commerce exports · **PBE-II** = other commercial goods · customs declarations **CN 22 / CN 23**
- Natural persons (not firms) → **no PBE** needed
- Products: registered packets (2 kg), air parcels (20 kg), International Tracked Packet, EMS

Ways to send money · Mind map



💸 Money order rules

- MO form **25 paise** (not adjusted in the commission) · form + amount + commission at the window in cash / cheque · receipt given
- PO **not** responsible for: wrong payment due to wrong details from the remitter · accidental delay / refusal · wrong payment after **1 year** from issue
- Acknowledgement of payment sent to the remitter · for e-MO it stays in the HO and is sent on demand
- Illiterate payee → puts his mark before a **witness** who signs
- Payee moved and left redirection instructions → redirected **free**
- Changing the address / PO → **free** · IMP changing the payee's **name** → **second commission** (equal to the first) · stopping payment → free
- Payee refuses → returned to the remitter at once, **free** · on request / payee not found → detained max **7 days**
- Can't be paid or repaid → **void**, amount credited to the Central Govt · paid later if applied within **1 year**
- The DG can suspend MO issue at any PO (except MOs at a higher special commission)

👀 At a glance: money

5%	₹5000	18	16	$2500
MO commission	one e-MO	PNR digits	IMO digits	foreign limit

30
times a year

⚠️ Exam trap

Changing the address is **free**, but changing the payee's **name** = a **second commission**.

💡 Remember

e-MO "**5000-100-6**" = ₹5000 · 100 characters · 6 payees

Stamps and philately

When	What
1 May 1840	World's first adhesive stamp, the **Penny Black** (Britain)
1852	India's first stamp, "Scinde District Dawk", circular, embossed
21 Nov 1947	First stamp of independent India: the flag + "**Jai Hind**", three and a half annas
21 June 1941	First philatelic bureau, **Bombay GPO**
1.8.1965	Domestic Philatelic Deposit Account (PDA) started
2011	**My Stamp** launched at INDIPEX-2011 PYQ · Rajasthan 2021 · Andhra 2021

- **Commemorative stamps** → events, people, nature · only at philatelic bureaux / counters / PDA · proposals from **any citizen** PYQ · Delhi 2022
- Smaller events → **Special Covers** + special cancellation (private parties too, on payment)
- **Definitive stamps** → from 25 paise, at all POs · in use for at least **5 years**
- **Philatelic bureau** = a branch of an HO / SO · **special** cancellation on FDCs · keeps PDAs
- **Philatelic counter** = at all HOs · only a standard "**First Day of Issue**" cancellation · registers PDAs
- **PDA** (at the philatelic bureau PYQ · Haryana 2022): minimum **₹200** · top up with at least ₹200 · inoperative if short, closed after 3 months · foreign: **₹1000**, Bombay bureau, min order ₹500, 2% (min ₹5) handling
- **National Philatelic Museum** → Dak Bhawan, Sansad Marg, New Delhi

My Stamp

- Stamp sheets with your photo / logo · one sheet = **12 stamps × ₹5** (sheet **₹300**) PYQ · Bihar 2021 · Delhi 2022
- Corporates: at least **100 sheets**, 10% off the first 100 + 20% beyond · collect within **7 working days**
- **Customised My Stamp**: at least **5000 sheets**, 20% discount (₹12 lakh total) · India Post prints 1000 extra · orders can't change, no refunds

Deen Dayal SPARSH Yojana + PAC

- SPARSH = philately scholarship · total **920** · max **40** per circle (10 each from classes VI, VII, VIII, IX)

- **₹6000 a year** (₹500 a month), quarterly into IPPB / POSB · selection: philately quiz + project · must be in the school's philately club
- **PAC** (Philatelic Advisory Committee): chaired by the **Minister for Communications**, co-chaired by the MoS · 1 MP each from Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha + eminent philatelists

👀 At a glance: philately

1840	1947	1941	₹200	12×₹5
Penny Black	Jai Hind stamp	first bureau	PDA	My Stamp

920
SPARSH

⚠️ **Exam trap**

Bureau = **special** cancellation · counter = only **"First Day of Issue"**.

💡 **Remember**

"40-41-47": 1840 world's stamp · 1941 first bureau · 1947 free India's stamp

👴 NPS (National Pension System)

- Voluntary retirement savings · regulator **PFRDA** · CRA = **NSDL** · DOP = a **POP** (Point of Presence), at all HOs
- Age **18–70**, Indian citizens (NRIs too) · NRI / OCI: **Tier-I** only · mandatory for govt employees (per the notes, except WB, Rajasthan, Chhattisgarh), optional for others
- Benefits: world's lowest-cost pension scheme · simple · flexible (choose your fund) · portable (even if city / job changes)
- Tax: own contribution 80CCD(1), 10% of salary (within ₹1.5 lakh, 80CCE) · employer's 80CCD(2), 10% over and above · extra **₹50,000** under 80CCD(1B)
- **Tier-I** (retirement, tax benefit): **₹500** at opening and each time, at least **₹1000** a year or the account is frozen
- **Tier-II** (savings, withdraw any time, no tax benefit): **₹1000** at opening, no yearly minimum
- **PRAN** = **12 digits** (from the CRA) · e-PRAN via the 17-digit acknowledgement · PAN for cash over ₹50,000
- Charges: registration ₹200 · service ₹30 · withdrawal ₹125 · nominee change ₹20

Exit	Into annuity	Full lump sum if corpus
At 60	at least **40%**	below ₹5 lakh
Before 60 (after 10 years)	at least **80%**	below ₹2.5 lakh
Death	**100%** to the nominee	

Lump sum and contributions can be deferred up to **75** (choose 15 days before turning 60) · Mutual funds: select **UTI** schemes only

🛡️ Jan Suraksha schemes

PMSBY (accident insurance)

- Age **18–70** · through one account only
- Premium **₹20 a year**, auto-debit before 1 June
- Cover **1 June – 31 May**
- Death / total disability → **₹2 lakh**
- Public sector / general insurers

PMJJBY (life insurance)

- Age **18–50**
- Premium **₹436** (Jun–Aug) · ₹342 (Sep–Nov) · ₹228 (Dec–Feb) · ₹114 (Mar–May)
- Cover 1 June – 31 May · **30-day** lien (except accidents)
- LIC / life insurers

👀 At a glance: NPS and insurance

18–70	12	40%	₹20	₹436
NPS / PMSBY age	PRAN digits	annuity at 60	PMSBY	PMJJBY

18–50
PMJJBY age

⚠️ Exam trap

PMSBY = **accident**, ₹20, up to 70 · PMJJBY = **life**, ₹436, up to 50.

💡 Remember

"**S = Small (₹20), J = Jeevan / life (₹436)**"

✍️ Test yourself

1. Max amount of one e-MO?
2. How many inward foreign remittances a year per person?
3. First stamp of independent India?
4. How many stamps on a My Stamp sheet?
5. How many digits in a PRAN?
6. PMSBY premium?

Answers: 1 ₹5000 · 2 30 · 3 21 Nov 1947 · 4 12 (₹5 each) · 5 12 · 6 ₹20

Source: PO Guide Part 1 · MTS / Postman notes, pages 82–108, condensed

PO Guide Part I · Short Notes ✍️

Part 5: APY · BNPL and COD · Bill Mail · Direct / Media / Business / Logistics Post · e-Payment, e-Post · citizen services (Aadhaar, passport, Jeevan Pramaan, gold bonds) · PLI and RPLI

Yellow = must remember IMP = asked often 📝 PYQ · State-Year = came in a past paper

👴 Atal Pension Yojana (APY)

- Announced in the **2015-16 budget** · run by **PFRDA** through the NPS set-up
- IMP Age **18–40** · **one** account per person · pension amount can be changed **once a year**
- Govt co-contribution: **50% or ₹1000** a year (whichever is lower) → for non-taxpayers who joined 1 June–31 Dec 2015
- Late payment penalty: **₹1 per month** for every ₹100
- Exit at 60 with pension · on death → pension to the spouse → after both, corpus to the nominee
- **No** exit before 60, except on death or terminal illness
- PMJJBY: cover ends at age 55 · even with many accounts, cover limited to ₹2 lakh

🏢 For bulk customers

BNPL (Book Now Pay Later)

- Contract customers of Speed Post / Business Post · bulk customer = at least **₹10,000** of Speed Post a month
- Approval: Director / Chief PM in GPOs, Divisional Head elsewhere · registration within **2 days** · below ₹10,000 → CPMG / PMG, 7 days
- Booking at many locations: **₹1 lakh a month** · **National Account Facility**: across circles, **₹1 crore a year**
- 3-year agreement → bank guarantee valid **39 months** · renewed 2 years at a time
- Bill monthly, by the **7th** · pay by the month's last day, or a **12%** penalty

COD (Cash on Delivery)

- Contract customers of Business Parcel, Express Parcel, Speed Post · up to **₹50,000** collected from the addressee
- Insurance **not compulsory** · no coupons / Snowball schemes · delivered to anyone at the address on payment

Bill Mail Service (BMS)

- Bills, account statements · at least **once in 90 days** · at least **5000** articles at a time
- Postage: up to 50 g **₹3** + ₹2 per 50 g · "Bill Mail Service" in bold at the top middle · hand over PIN-sorted
- Within a city / district · adverts allowed, but not a purely publicity item
- **NBMS** (national): anywhere in India · first class, by air

📣 Direct, Media, Business, Logistics Post

- IMP **Direct Post** = **unaddressed** mail (leaflets, brochures, samples, CDs) 📝 PYQ · MP 2022 · started **2 June 2005** · at least **1000** · not in letter boxes, in bulk · **5%** discount above ₹0,000
- **Media Post** = advertising through the post (postcards, ILCs, MO forms, mail vans, PO buildings) · apply to the Divisional Head, licence from the Circle Head · aerogrammes in **English only** · 4 colours · min 10 lakh (multi-colour) / 5 lakh (single colour)
- **Business Post** = from mail preparation to delivery (collecting, franking, inserting, sealing) · Business Post Centres · annual reports on cash prepayment (special licence)
- **Logistics Post** = collection → storage → transmission → distribution · **no upper weight limit** · minimum chargeable **50 kg** (multiples of 10 kg) · FTL / LTL · road, rail, air
- Logistics: door to door ₹1 / kg (min ₹100) · airport ₹1 / kg (min ₹50) · unloading free up to 500 kg, then ₹1000 per ton

💻 e-Payment, e-Post, Retail Post

- **e-Payment** = many people paying one organisation (electricity, phone bills, fees, taxes) · **14,000+** POs · to become a biller, apply to the **CPMG** · MIS with 5 fields
- **e-Post** = message over the internet, printed and delivered · retail **₹10 per A4 page** + GST · corporate ₹6 (₹5 for 50+ messages)
- **Retail Post** = third-party services at POs: bills, taxes, forms, railway tickets · network of 1.5 lakh+ POs

Citizen services

Service	Key point
Aadhaar	New enrolment **free** · updates (name, address, photo, fingerprints, iris) for a fee
POPSK (passport)	DOP + Ministry of External Affairs · **429** centres · PCC at **214**
Railway tickets (PRS)	**333** POs, where there's no railway counter
Jeevan Pramaan	Digital life certificate for pensioners, Aadhaar biometrics · **810 HOs** · from **30-06-2015** · at home via IPPB for **₹70**
Gangajal / prasad	Select POs + e-commerce portal · prasad from shrines (Tirupati, Baidyanath Dham etc.)
Rakhi envelope	Non-tearable, waterproof · kit **₹25** · unregistered rakhi mail = first class
Magazine Post	With tracking · from PSOs in 10 cities · pilot 1 March 2022 (Delhi, Mumbai)

Sovereign Gold Bonds (SGB)

- 1 unit = **1 gram** of gold · **2.5%** interest on top of the gold price rise, paid half-yearly
- Tenure **8 years**, exit from the 5th year · min 1 g · max **4 kg** (individual / HUF), 20 kg (trusts)
- Residents of India only · tradable on stock exchanges · **no** capital gains tax on redemption

👀 At a glance: services

18–40	₹10,000	₹50,000	5000	1000
APY age	BNPL / month	COD limit	Bill Mail min	Direct Post min

429	810
POPSKs	Jeevan Pramaan HOs

⚠️ **Exam trap**
Direct Post = **unaddressed** mail, **not** posted in letter boxes.

💡 **Remember**
Logistics = "**minimum 50, maximum none**"

PLI / RPLI · Mind map

PLI
started **1 Feb 1884**
PYQ · Bihar 2020 · MP 2022
max ₹50 lakh
PYQ · Chhattisgarh · Assam 2021

Suraksha (Whole Life)
Paid at 80 or on death · loan after **4 years** · surrender after 3 years · convertible to Endowment up to 59 · premium till 55 / 58 / 60

Suvidha (Convertible)
Whole Life, convert to Endowment **after 5, before 6 years** · if not, stays Whole Life · loan after 4 years

Santosh (Endowment)
Paid at a chosen age: 35, 40, 45, 50, 55, 58, 60 · loan after **3 years** · surrender before 5 years = no bonus

Yugal Suraksha
Husband and wife, **one** premium · age **21–45** · loan / surrender after 3 years

Sumangal (Money Back)
15 yrs: 20% each at 6, 9, 12, then 40% · 20 yrs: 20% each at 8, 12, 16, then 40% · age 19 to 40 / 45

Bal Jeevan Bima
Max **2 children**, age **5–20** · parent under 45 · PLI ₹3 lakh, RPLI ₹1 lakh (or the parent's, whichever is less) · no premium after parent's death · no medical

PLI and RPLI: other points

- PLI began for postal employees · **1894**: female employees too (when no other insurer covered women) · now central / state govt, defence, PSUs, banks, teachers, doctors, engineers, CAs, lawyers etc.
- IMP **RPLI** started **24.03.1995** · on the **Malhotra Committee** (1993) recommendation PYQ · MP 2022 · then only 22% insured, life insurance = 10% of household savings
- Aim: rural people, weaker sections, rural women workers
- RPLI also has: Gram Suraksha, Gram Suvidha, Gram Santosh, Gram Sumangal (max ₹10 lakh), Bal Jeevan Bima · RPLI (Gram Suraksha) max **₹10 lakh** PYQ · Assam 2022
- **Gram Priya** (RPLI only): **10 years** · 20% at 4 years, 20% at 7, 60% + bonus at 10 · ₹10,000 to ₹10 lakh · no interest on arrears up to 1 year in floods / disasters
- RPLI loan: after 3 years (Endowment) PYQ · Kerala 2021
- PLI money back policy = **Sumangal** PYQ · UP 2020 · farmers are not eligible for PLI (they go under RPLI) PYQ · Delhi 2022 · Bihar 2021

👀 At a glance: insurance

1884	1995	₹50 lakh	₹10 lakh	5–20
PLI began	RPLI began	PLI max	RPLI max	Bal Jeevan

21–45
Yugal Suraksha

⚠️ **Exam trap**

Whole Life loan after **4 years**, Endowment (Santosh) loan after **3 years**.

💡 **Remember**

PLI names: "**Suraksha-Suvidha-Santosh-Yugal-Sumangal-Bal**" · RPLI adds "Gram" + Gram Priya

✍️ Test yourself

1. Up to what age can one join APY?
2. When did Direct Post start?
3. RPLI came on which committee's advice?
4. Name of the PLI money back policy?
5. Max weight for Logistics Post?
6. Jeevan Pramaan centres are in how many HOs?

Answers: 1 18–40 · 2 2 June 2005 · 3 Malhotra Committee · 4 Sumangal · 5 No limit · 6 810

Source: PO Guide Part I · MTS / Postman notes, pages 109–135, condensed

PO Guide Part I · Short Notes ✍️

Part 6 (last): PLI / RPLI FAQs · Post Office savings schemes (SB, RD, TD, MIS, SCSS, PPF, SSA, NSC, KVP, MSSC, PM CARES) · ePassbook · claims · ATM

Yellow = must remember IMP = asked often PYQ · State-Year = came in a past paper

🛡️ PLI / RPLI: key FAQs

- **Advantage**: low premium + high bonus · tax benefit under **80C** · pay at any PO or the online portal · toll free **1800 266 6868**
- **Lapse**: **6** unpaid premiums for a policy under 3 years, **12** for older ones · revival any number of times if 5 consecutive years haven't passed · dues + **12%** interest + health certificate · up to 12 instalments
- Missed one month → pay next month with a **1%** fine
- IMP **No medical needed**: up to **₹2 lakh** at any age · PLI up to ₹5 lakh (age ≤ 40) · RPLI up to ₹1 lakh (age ≤ 35) · non-medical policies: deduction on death claim within 3 years
- **Loan**: WLA and CWLA after **4 years** (EA after 3) · **not** in AEA (Sumangal) and children's policy · interest **10%**, half-yearly
- **Surrender**: WLA, EA, CWLA, Yugal Suraksha after **3 years** · **not** in AEA and children's policy · bonus on reduced sum only if surrendered after 5 years
- **Advance premium rebate**: PLI 6 months 1%, 12 months 2% · RPLI 3 months 0.5%, 6 months 1%, 12 months 2% · ₹1 a month rebate per ₹20,000 sum assured
- Only one spouse eligible → **Yugal Suraksha** · always nominate · death claim rejected → appeal to the next higher authority
- Eligible: central / state employees, **GDS**, defence, paramilitary, PSUs, banks, educational institutions, doctors, engineers, CAs, lawyers, employees of NSE / BSE listed companies · RPLI = all rural residents

> ⚠️ **Exam trap**
> Sumangal (AEA) and Bal Jeevan Bima have **no loan and no surrender**.

> 💡 **Remember**
> PLI loan interest **10%**, revival interest **12%**

Post Office savings schemes: one table

Scheme	Minimum	Maximum	Term / key point
SB	₹500	—	A minor above 10 can open in own name PYQ · Telangana 2020 · close any time
RD	₹100 / month	no limit PYQ · Haryana 2022	5 years · can close after 3
TD	₹1000	no limit	1 / 2 / 3 / 5 years · interest yearly
MIS	₹1000	₹9 lakh (joint ₹15 lakh)	5 years · interest monthly
SCSS	₹1000	₹30 lakh	5 years · interest quarterly · close **any time** PYQ · Kerala 2021
PPF	₹500 / year PYQ · MP 2020	₹1.5 lakh / year	15 years
SSA	₹250 PYQ · Haryana 2022	₹1.5 lakh / year	21 years · girl under 10
NSC	₹1000	no limit	5 years · no early closure
KVP	₹1000	no limit	can close after 2.5 years
MSSC	₹1000	₹2 lakh	2 years · 7.5%

80C benefit: 5-year TD, SCSS, PPF, SSA, NSC · SB interest under 80TTA (up to ₹10,000)

1 Savings Account (SB)

- Single adult · joint (2–3) · **minor above 10** in own name · guardian for a minor / person of unsound mind
- One single account per person · single ↔ joint conversion **not** allowed · nomination **mandatory**
- Minimum **₹500**, then not less than ₹10 · below ₹500 at year end → **₹50** maintenance fee, closed if it hits zero
- Interest: on the minimum balance from the **10th to month end**, credited at year end · 80TTA exemption up to ₹10,000
- No transaction for **3 financial years** → **silent** account · revived with KYC
- Cheque book, ATM, net / mobile banking (within DOP only) · cheque bounce **₹50**

2 Recurring Deposit (RD)

- Minimum **₹100 a month**, multiples of ₹10 · opened 1st–15th → pay by the **15th** each month · opened after 16th → by the last working day
- Default: **₹1** per ₹100 per month · **4** defaults → discontinued, revivable within 2 months · with up to 4 defaults the term can be extended by those months
- Advance: up to 5 years · on a ₹100 account, 6 instalments → ₹10 rebate, 12 → ₹40
- IMP Loan: after **12 instalments** + 1 year, **50%** of the balance · interest = RD rate + 2%
- Premature closure: after **3 years** (SB rate) · extendable 5 more years (original rate) · can be kept 5 years without deposits
- On death the nominee may continue it till maturity

3 Time Deposit (TD)

- Minimum **₹1000**, multiples of ₹100, no maximum · interest **yearly** (no interest on unclaimed interest)
- **5-year TD** → 80C · extension: 1-year within 6 months, 2-year within 12 months, 3 / 5-year within 18 months of maturity
- Premature: after **6 months** · closed after 1 year → **2% less** than that term's rate
- IMP A 5-year TD opened on / after 10-11-2023 can't be closed for **4 years** · can be pledged (banks, RBI, co-operatives, govt companies)

4 Monthly Income Scheme (MIS)

- Minimum **₹1000** (multiples of ₹1000) · max **₹9 lakh** single, **₹15 lakh** joint (equal shares) · a minor's limit is separate
- Interest every month, no interest on unclaimed interest · auto credit to SB / ECS
- **No** closure before 1 year · 1–3 years → **2%** cut from principal · 3–5 years → **1%** · full at 5 years

5 Senior Citizens Savings Scheme (SCSS)

- IMP Age **60+** · retired civilians **55–60** · retired defence **50–60** (within **1 month** of retirement benefits)
- Single or jointly with the **spouse only** · the whole joint deposit belongs to the first holder
- Minimum ₹1000 · maximum **₹30 lakh** · 80C · interest **quarterly** · TDS if interest exceeds ₹50,000 (not with ISG / ISH)

- Close **any time**: before 1 year → no interest · 1–2 years → 1.5% cut · 2–5 years → 1% · after 5 years extend by **3 years**

6 Public Provident Fund (PPF)

- **One** account in the whole country (PO or bank) · **₹500 to ₹1.5 lakh** a year, multiples of ₹50 · 80C · interest at year end
- No ₹500 in a year → discontinued · revive: ₹500 + **₹50** per defaulted year · no loan / withdrawal on discontinued accounts
- **Loan**: after 1 year from the end of the opening year, before 5 years · **25%** of the balance at the end of the second preceding year · repaid within 36 months → **1%** interest, later → 6%
- **Withdrawal**: after 5 years, once a year, up to **50%**
- Matures after **15 financial years** · extend in blocks of **5 years** within 1 year (with deposits, up to 60% withdrawal)
- Premature closure (after 5 years): serious illness, higher education, becoming an NRI → 1% less interest · on death it closes, the nominee can **not** continue it

7 Sukanya Samriddhi Account (SSA)

- Girl **below 10**, opened by the guardian · one account per girl · max **2** girls per family (exception for twins / triplets)
- Minimum **₹250**, max ₹1.5 lakh a year · deposits for **15 years** · default → revive with ₹250 + ₹50 per year · 80C
- Guardian operates till 18 · **50%** withdrawal after **18** or **passing 10th** 📝 PYQ · UP 2020 (once a year, max 5 times)
- Closure: at **21 years** · or on marriage after 18 · after 5 years: death / extreme compassion

8–11 NSC, KVP, MSSC, PM CARES

- **NSC (VIII)**: single or up to **3 adults** joint · from ₹1000, no limit · **5 years** · 80C · can be pledged · **no** early closure (except death or forfeiture)
- **KVP**: from ₹1000, no limit · maturity set by the govt (doubles in 115 months) · closure: on death or after **2.5 years** · can be pledged
- **Mahila Samman Savings Certificate (MSSC)**: ₹1000 to **₹2 lakh** · **3-month** gap between two accounts · **7.5%**, compounded quarterly · **40%** withdrawal after 1 year · closable after 6 months without reason · matures in **2 years**

- **PM CARES for Children 2021**: children who lost parents to COVID (11.03.2020 to 28.02.2022) · **DM** as joint holder · corpus **₹10 lakh** at 18 · monthly stipend from MIS interest till 23 · ₹10 lakh paid at 23

📱 ePassbook, claims, ATM

- **ePassbook**: via OTP · balance + mini statement (SB, PPF, SSA) · full statement in phases
- Death claim: with nomination → form + death certificate · without nomination, **up to ₹5 lakh** → affidavits etc., **6 months** after death · above ₹5 lakh → legal evidence (succession certificate etc.)
- Account transfer: form **SB-10(B)** · duplicate certificate → as a passbook, from the HO (no indemnity bond for mutilated ones)
- ATM: **₹25,000** a day, ₹10,000 per transaction · free at other banks: **3** in metros, **5** elsewhere, then ₹20 + GST · card replacement ₹300 · annual ₹125 · SMS ₹12

👀 At a glance: savings

₹500 SB / PPF	**₹100** RD	**₹250** SSA	**₹9/15 lakh** MIS	**₹30 lakh** SCSS
₹1.5 lakh PPF / SSA a year	**15 / 21** PPF / SSA years			

⚠️ **Exam trap**
SCSS can be closed **any time** (with a cut), but NSC can **not** be closed early. MIS **not** before 1 year.

💡 **Remember**
Minimums "**100-250-500-1000**" = RD · SSA · SB/PPF · all the rest

✍️ Test yourself

1. From what age can a minor open an SB account alone?
2. When is the 50% SSA withdrawal allowed?
3. Maximum deposit in SCSS?
4. Loan available on an RD?
5. PPF matures in how many years?
6. MSSC maximum?

Answers: 1 Above 10 · 2 After 18 or passing 10th · 3 ₹30 lakh · 4 50% (after 12 instalments) · 5 15 financial years · 6 ₹2 lakh

Source: PO Guide Part I · MTS / Postman notes, pages 136–162, condensed · interest rates change every quarter